

InnovaForge

Toolkit – 2026

Templates and worksheets for the five stages, from spark
to scale



Ignite



Forge



Temper



Sculpt



Polish

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InnovaForge Toolkit

The templates and worksheets of "InnovaForge: From Spark to Scale" (2026), the white paper on a five-stage framework for innovation by Prof. Dr. Mohamed Fawzi Elgendi. This toolkit replaces the worksheets first published with InnovaForge Framework V1.0.



Open, all of it

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COMPANION FILES

A fillable workbook with the same sheets, in English and Arabic, accompanies this edition. The white paper itself, with the cases and the evidence, is on www.fawzooz.ai.

The cases and techniques referred to are summarized from the published sources listed at the end. Trademarks belong to their respective owners.

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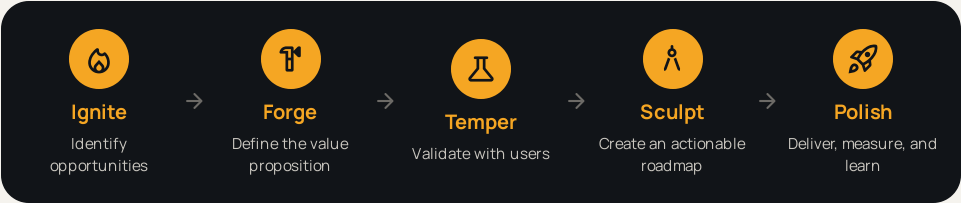
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BEFORE YOU START

How to use the toolkit

InnovaForge is five iterative stages that form a continuous cycle. This toolkit gives every stage its worksheets and closes each one with a gate built from its exit criteria. The canvas is the single source of truth that ties them together.



🔄 Learnings from Polish feed the next Ignite.

1. Open a project with the kick-off charter (0.1) and the canvas (0.2). Fill in Ignite together at kick-off.
2. Work through the stage's sheets. Use the ones the project needs; each sheet says what it feeds on the canvas.
3. Close each stage at its exit gate. If a criterion is not met, loop back: iteration is the method, not a failure.
4. Revisit the canvas at every milestone, and use it to report progress to stakeholders.
5. After the launch, hold the retrospective and carry its findings into the next Ignite.



Collaborate with purpose

Psychological safety and diverse perspectives produce stronger ideas.



Embrace iteration

Failure is data, not an endpoint.



Adapt and evolve

A guide, not a rigid process: scale the sheets to the project.



Start here

- 0.1 Kick-off charter
- 0.2 The InnovaForge Canvas

0.1

Project _____

Date _____

Kick-off charter

One page to open the project: who is in the room, what the challenge is, and when each stage should close.

 **The challenge, as a question: “How might we...?”**

 **Who it is for**

 **Why now**

 **The team: mix perspectives, from engineering to marketing to customer support**

Name	Role in the project	Perspective they bring

 **Milestones: when each stage closes and the canvas is reviewed**

Stage	Gate date	Canvas review with
1 · Ignite		
2 · Forge		
3 · Temper		
4 · Sculpt		
5 · Polish		

 **Our ground rules**

- ☐ Anyone can speak up, and no idea is laughed at.
- ☐ Failure is data: we write down what each failed test taught us.
- ☐ We adapt the sheets to the project, not the project to the sheets.

The InnovaForge Canvas

The single source of truth: fill in Ignite together at kick-off, revisit it at every milestone, and use it to report progress.

 Stage 1 Ignite	 Problems & opportunities	 Inspiration sources	 Idea bank
 Stage 2 Forge	 Concept statement	 Value proposition	 Low-fi prototype
 Stage 3 Temper	 Riskiest assumptions	 User feedback	 Learnings & pivots
 Stage 4 Sculpt	 Goals & OKRs	 Roadmap & sprints	 Resources & risks
 Stage 5 Polish	 Launch plan	 Impact metrics	 Next step

Stage 1 of 5

Ignite

The Spark of Insight



OBJECTIVE

Move from broad curiosity to a specific, well-defined problem or opportunity worth exploring.



CORE ACTION

Identify opportunities



Activities: Problem finding beneath surface issues; inspiration mining across reports, competitors, customers and unrelated fields; and open, judgment-free brainstorming.



Techniques: Brainstorming, the 5 Whys, Provocation.



Exit criteria: One to three prioritized problems or opportunities and a bank of initial ideas, recorded on the canvas.

SHEETS IN THIS STAGE

- 1.1** Five Whys: find the root cause
- 1.2** Inspiration mining
- 1.3** Brainstorm and provocation
- 1.4** Prioritize problems and opportunities



Project _____ Date _____

Five Whys: find the root cause

Start from a fact you have seen. Ask “why?” of each answer until you reach something you can act on and prevent.

The problem we observed

Why? 1

Why? 2

Why? 3

Why? 4

Why? 5

Root cause, in one sentence

- ☐ We can act on it
- ☐ We can prevent it
- ☐ Each “because” leads to the next

Example · Toyota: the machine stopped → the fuse blew → a bearing was not lubricated → the pump was not pumping → its shaft was worn → scrap got in: there was no strainer. The fix was a strainer, not a new fuse (Ohno, 1988).

Feeds the canvas: **Problems & opportunities**



Project _____ Date _____

Inspiration mining

Look across reports, competitors, customers and fields nobody here reads. Write what you saw, then what it suggests for your problem.

Source	What we saw	What it suggests
Reports and research		
Competitors		
Customers		
Customers		
An unrelated field		
An unrelated field		

 The pattern across sources

 Feeds the canvas: Inspiration sources



Project _____ Date _____

Brainstorm and provocation

Brainstorm first, with judgment switched off; then use a provocation to reach ideas brainstorming will not. Judge only at the end.

How might we...? _____

- Defer judgment
- Build on others' ideas
- Go for quantity

1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16

Provocation de Bono (1970)

What everyone takes for granted

Po: reverse, remove or exaggerate it

What would follow from it

Feeds the canvas: **Idea bank**



Project _____ Date _____

Prioritize problems and opportunities

Score each candidate from 1 (low) to 5 (high) on each criterion, add the scores, and keep the top one to three.

Problem or opportunity	Impact	Urgency	Evidence	Fit	Total
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Impact: How much it matters to the people affected.

Evidence: How sure we are it is real.

Urgency: What it costs to wait.

Fit: How well it fits our mission and means.

Our priorities, one to three

1

2

3

Exit gate 1

Project

Date _____

Close Ignite

One to three prioritized problems or opportunities and a bank of initial ideas, recorded on the canvas.

IS EVERY CRITERION MET?

We looked beneath the surface issue and wrote down a root cause, not a symptom.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

Inspiration came from at least three kinds of source, one of them an unrelated field.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

We brainstormed with judgment switched off, and kept every idea in the bank.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

One to three problems or opportunities are ranked by priority.

☐ Yes ☐ Not vet

The three Ignite boxes on the canvas are filled in.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

 Evidence: where each criterion is shown

DECISION

☐ Go to Forge ☐ Loop back within this stage ☐ Return to Ignite

What we still need, and by when

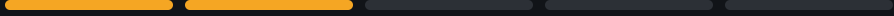
 Copy the stage's results into the Ignite row of the canvas (0.2) before you move on.

Stage 2 of 5



Forge

Shaping the Concept



OBJECTIVE

Transform raw ideas into structured, testable concepts with a clear value proposition.



CORE ACTION

Define the value proposition



Activities: Concept statements that define purpose, audience and features; a thirty-minute Lean Canvas; and low-fidelity prototypes such as sketches, wireframes or a “future press release”.



Techniques: SCAMPER, TRIZ, Mind mapping.



Exit criteria: A clear value proposition and a low-fidelity prototype ready for first feedback.

SHEETS IN THIS STAGE

- 2.1** Concept statement
- 2.2** SCAMPER
- 2.3** TRIZ: resolve the contradiction
- 2.4** Mind map
- 2.5** Lean Canvas in thirty minutes
- 2.6** Low-fi prototype and future press release

Concept statement

Define the concept's purpose, audience and features, then say its value in one sentence somebody outside the team can hold.

 Purpose: what it is for

 Audience: who it is for

- ☰ Features: what it does

THE STATEMENT

For audience who need, concept name is a kind of thing that key benefit. Unlike current alternative, it the difference.

 The value proposition, in one sentence



Project _____ Date _____

SCAMPER

Put one idea through the seven prompts. Write at least one answer for each, even a weak one, then star the two or three that change the value most.

The idea we are working on

Substitute

What part, material or person could be swapped?

Combine

What could it be merged with?

Adapt

What else is like this, elsewhere?

Modify

What could be bigger, smaller, faster, other?

Put to another use

Who else could use it, and how?

Eliminate

What could be removed or simplified?

Reverse

What if the order, roles or direction were flipped?

Feeds the canvas: **Concept statement**



Project _____ Date _____

TRIZ: resolve the contradiction

When improving one thing makes another worse, write the contradiction, then try inventive principles that remove it rather than balance it.

We want to improve...

...but then this gets worse

The contradiction: "We want X, but then Y."

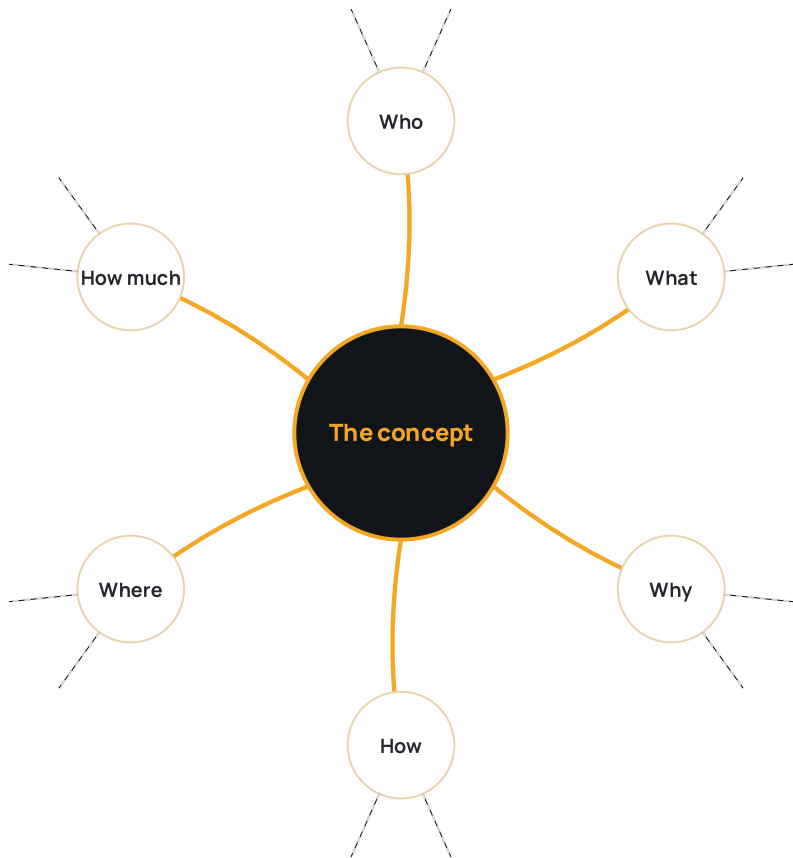
Principle (of Altshuller's forty)		Our idea with it
1	Segmentation Divide it into independent parts.	
2	Taking out Separate the part that causes trouble.	
3	Local quality Make each part fit its own job.	
5	Merging Bring similar operations together.	
6	Universality Let one part do several jobs.	
10	Prior action Do the work, or part of it, in advance.	
13	The other way round Invert the action or the order.	
15	Dynamics Let it adapt or change as it is used.	

The solution that removes the contradiction

Feeds the canvas: **Concept statement** · **Value proposition**

Mind map

Write the concept in the centre. Grow one-word branches from the six questions, then link the branches that touch: those links are often the concept.





Project _____ Date _____

Lean Canvas in thirty minutes

Break the idea into its key assumptions in half an hour, in the numbered order. Circle the "!" on the boxes you are least sure of: they go to Temper.

1

Customer segments

Who has the problem? Who are the early adopters?

2

Problem

Top one to three problems, and today's alternatives.

3

Unique value proposition

One clear message: why it is different and worth attention.

4

Solution

The top features, one per problem.

5

Channels

How you reach the customers.

6

Revenue streams

How it pays, or who funds it.

7

Cost structure

What it costs to build and run.

8

Key metrics

The numbers that show it is working.

9

Unfair advantage

What cannot easily be copied or bought.

⌚ After Maurya, Running Lean (2012). Ten minutes for 1–3, ten for 4–6, ten for 7–9.

📄 Feeds the canvas: **Value proposition** · **Riskiest assumptions**



Project _____ Date _____

Low-fi prototype and future press release

Make something people can react to: sketch it, or write the press release for a day that has not come yet.

 **Sketch or wireframe**

 **Future press release** Dated _____

Headline

Who gets what

The problem it ends

 **A user's words**

How to start using it

 Feeds the canvas: **Low-fi prototype**

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Exit gate 2

Project

Date _____

Close Forge

A clear value proposition and a low-fidelity prototype ready for first feedback.

IS EVERY CRITERION MET?

The concept statement names its purpose, its audience and its features.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

The value proposition fits in one sentence that someone outside the team understands.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

The Lean Canvas is complete, and its riskiest boxes are marked.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

A low-fidelity prototype exists: a sketch, a wireframe or a future press release.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

The three Forge boxes on the canvas are filled in.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

 Evidence: where each criterion is shown

DECISION

☐ Go to Temper ☐ Loop back within this stage ☐ Return to Ignite

What we still need, and by when

 Copy the stage's results into the Forge row of the canvas (0.2) before you move on.

Stage 3 of 5



Temper

Testing and Iteration



OBJECTIVE

Expose the concept to real-world feedback and data, strengthening it through rapid cycles of learning.



CORE ACTION

Validate with users



Activities: Build a minimum viable product; run interviews, analytics, A/B and usability tests with five to ten users per cycle; iterate or pivot on evidence through Build–Measure–Learn.



Techniques: Design Thinking, Storyboarding.



Exit criteria: Core assumptions validated or invalidated with real user data; learnings and pivots recorded.

SHEETS IN THIS STAGE

3.1

Assumption map

3.2

Test cards

3.3

User feedback log

3.4

Storyboard

3.5

Build–Measure–Learn and pivots

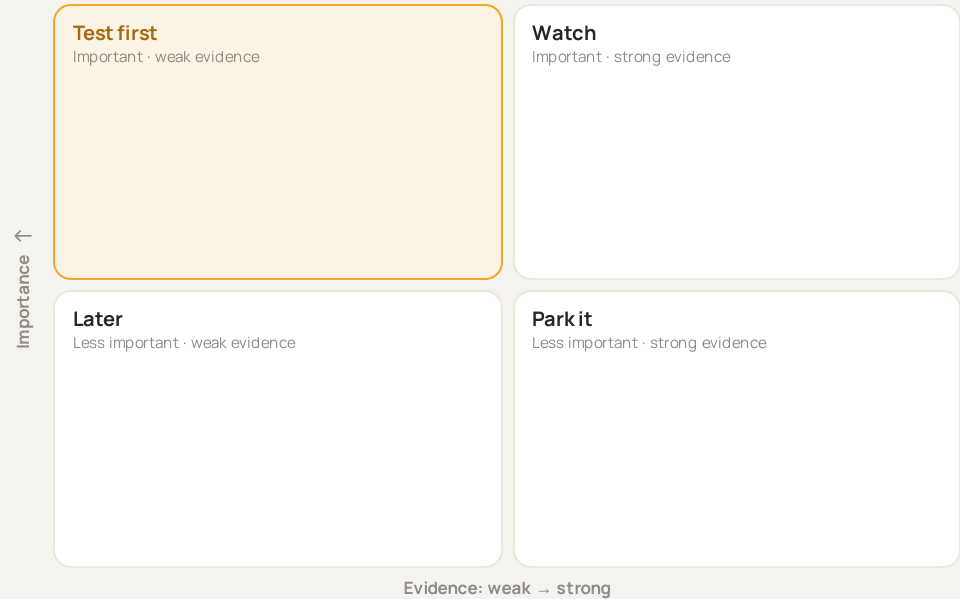


Project _____ Date _____

Assumption map

List what must be true for the concept to work. Place each one on the map: important and with little evidence means test it first.

#	We believe that...	Desirable · feasible · viable
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		



Feeds the canvas: **Riskiest assumptions**



Project _____ Date _____

Test cards

One card per riskiest assumption. Write the success signal before the test runs, so the result cannot move the goalposts.

Test 1

Assumption # _____ Owner _____

We believe that...

To verify, we will run

☐ Interviews

☐ Analytics

☐ A/B test

☐ Usability test

With (five to ten users)

We measure

We are right if... (written before the test)

What happened

☐ Validated

☐ Invalidated

Test 2

Assumption # _____ Owner _____

We believe that...

To verify, we will run

☐ Interviews

☐ Analytics

☐ A/B test

☐ Usability test

With (five to ten users)

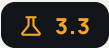
We measure

We are right if... (written before the test)

What happened

☐ Validated

☐ Invalidated



Project _____ Date _____

User feedback log

One row per user, five to ten per cycle. Write what they did before what they said: behavior is the stronger evidence.

Cycle _____ Method _____ Version tested _____

#	User	What they did	What they said	Surprise	Assumption ±
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					

 Feeds the canvas: **User feedback**



Project _____ Date _____

Storyboard

One user, one moment of need, six frames. Show it to users before anything is built, and mark the frames where they hesitate.

The user

Their moment of need

1 **Before**

2 **The trigger**

3 **First use**

4 **The key moment**

5 **The result**

6 **After**

Under each frame: what they do, and what they feel. The hand marks a frame where users hesitated.

Feeds the canvas: **User feedback**

 3.5

Project _____ Date _____

Build–Measure–Learn and pivots

Record every cycle. Each ends in a decision taken on evidence: persevere with the concept, or pivot to a new hypothesis.

 Build

→

 Measure

→

 Learn

↻

Cycle	What we built	What we measured	What we learned	Persevere · pivot
1				
2				
3				
4				

Pivot record

From	To	The evidence that made us turn

 Feeds the canvas: **Learnings & pivots**

Core assumptions validated or invalidated with real user data; learnings and pivots recorded.

The riskiest assumptions were named before anything was built.	☐ Yes	☐ Not yet
Each test had a success signal written down before it ran.	☐ Yes	☐ Not yet
Five to ten real users took part in each cycle.	☐ Yes	☐ Not yet
Every core assumption is marked validated or invalidated, with its evidence.	☐ Yes	☐ Not yet
Learnings and pivots are recorded, and the three Temper boxes on the canvas are filled in.	☐ Yes	☐ Not yet

☐ Go to Sculpt ☐ Loop back within this stage ☐ Return to Forge

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Stage 4 of 5



Sculpt

Planning for Impact



OBJECTIVE

Create a clear, actionable, strategic roadmap for developing and launching the validated solution.



CORE ACTION

Create an actionable roadmap



Activities: Strategic alignment with the mission; agile planning in user stories and sprints with OKRs and a three-to-six-month roadmap; resources, budget and a simple risk matrix.



Techniques: SWOT analysis, Six Thinking Hats.



Exit criteria: A roadmap with objectives and success metrics agreed by the team and stakeholders.

SHEETS IN THIS STAGE

4.1

Strategic alignment and SWOT

4.2

Six Thinking Hats review

4.3

Objectives and key results

4.4

Roadmap and sprints

4.5

Resources, budget and risks

Date _____

Tie the validated solution to the mission first. Then see it against its context, and pair the quadrants into roadmap items and risks.

How it serves it

inside

inside

outside

outside

⚠ Weakness × threat → risk



Project _____ Date _____

Six Thinking Hats review

Review the plan with everyone wearing the same hat at the same time. Blue opens and closes the session.

Blue · process

What are we deciding?

White · facts

What do we know, and what is missing?

Red · feelings

What is our gut telling us?

Black · risks

What could go wrong?

Yellow · benefits

What is the best case, and why?

Green · alternatives

What else could we do?

Blue, to close: what we decided, and what changes in the plan

 Feeds the canvas: Roadmap & sprints · Resources & risks

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 4.3

Project _____ Date _____

Objectives and key results

An objective says where you are going; its key results say, in numbers, how you will know you got there. These are the metrics Polish will track.

Objective 1

Key result: a number that shows the objective is met	Baseline	Target	Owner	By
1				
2				
3				

Objective 2

Key result: a number that shows the objective is met	Baseline	Target	Owner	By
1				
2				
3				

Objective 3

Key result: a number that shows the objective is met	Baseline	Target	Owner	By
1				
2				
3				

 Two to three key results per objective is enough (Doerr, 2018). Each needs a baseline today, or it cannot show change.

 Feeds the canvas: **Goals & OKRs**



Project _____ Date _____

Roadmap and sprints

Lay out three to six months by workstream, then break the first months into sprints of user stories, each with what “done” means.

Workstream	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Month 4	Month 5	Month 6
Product						
People and skills						
Users and market						
Operations						
Milestones						

Sprints and user stories

Sprint	As a..., I want..., so that...	Done when
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

 Feeds the canvas: Roadmap & sprints



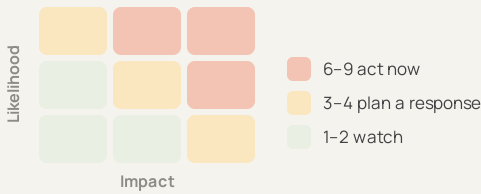
Project _____ Date _____

Resources, budget and risks

Write down what the roadmap needs and what could sink it. Score each risk as likelihood × impact, from 1 to 3 each, and give it an owner.

Resource: people, tools, space	How much	Cost

Total budget _____ Approved by _____



Risk	L	I	Score	Response	Owner
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					

 Feeds the canvas: **Resources & risks**

Exit gate 4

Project

Date _____

Close Sculpt

A roadmap with objectives and success metrics agreed by the team and stakeholders.

IS EVERY CRITERION MET?

The solution is tied to a line of the mission or strategy, in writing.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

Each objective has measurable key results, with a baseline and a target.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

The roadmap covers three to six months, broken into sprints and user stories.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

Resources, budget and the top risks are on paper, each risk with an owner.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

The team and the stakeholders have agreed the roadmap and its success metrics.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

 Evidence: where each criterion is shown

DECISION

 [Go to Polish](#)

- Loop back within this stage

☐ Return to Temper

What we still need, and by when

Team lead

Stakeholder

Stakeholder

00

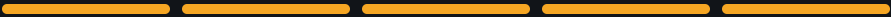
 Copy the stage's results into the Sculpt row of the canvas (0.2) before you move on.

Stage 5 of 5



Polish

Launch, Learn, and Scale



OBJECTIVE

Execute the plan, measure real-world impact, and embed the learnings back into the organization.



CORE ACTION

Deliver, measure, and learn



Activities: A full or phased launch guided by a checklist; tracking the OKRs and KPIs set in Sculpt; and a retrospective two to four weeks after launch: what worked, what did not, what we learned.



Exit criteria: Initial performance data analyzed and a decision taken: iterate, scale or sunset. The cycle begins anew.

SHEETS IN THIS STAGE

- 5.1** Launch checklist
- 5.2** Impact tracker
- 5.3** Retrospective
- 5.4** Decision and the next spark

Date _____

Choose a full or a phased launch, then work down the checklist. Nothing ships until every box is ticked or consciously waived.

🔊 Kind of launch

- ☐ Full: everyone at once ☐ Phased: one group at a time

Phase	Who gets it	From	Go on if...
1			
2			
3			

✓= Before launch

- ☐ The key results from Script (4.3) have a baseline.
- ☐ Tracking is live, and someone owns the dashboard.
- ☐ Users have a channel for feedback, and someone reads it.
- ☐ Support knows what is coming and how to answer.
- ☐ There is a way back if something breaks.
- ☐ Someone is on call for the first days.
- ☐ Legal, privacy and security have signed off.
- ☐ Stakeholders and users have been told.
- ☐ The retrospective is booked, two to four weeks out.
- ☐ The canvas is up to date.

Also needed for this launch

 Feeds the canvas: **Launch plan**



Project _____ Date _____

Impact tracker

Track the OKRs and KPIs set in Sculpt from day one. Read the trend, not a single number.

Launch date _____ Dashboard owner _____

Key result or KPI	Baseline	Target	Week 1	Week 2	Week 4	Trend

 on track  flat  off track

 **What the numbers say**

 Feeds the canvas: **Impact metrics**

Date _____

Held on Weeks since launch Present

Action	Owner	By when
1		
2		
3		
4		

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Date _____

Take the decision on the data: iterate, scale or sunset. Then write what this cycle hands to the next Ignite. The cycle begins anew.

 Iterate

It works in part: improve it and measure again.

 Scale

Key results are met: take it to more people or places.

☐ ☒ Sunset

The evidence says stop: close it well, and keep the lessons.

 The evidence behind the decision

📌 What scaling, iterating or closing will need

 Seeds for the next Ignite

Problems this cycle uncovered

Ideas we parked

What we will do differently

 Feeds the canvas: **Next step**

Initial performance data analyzed and a decision taken: iterate, scale or sunset. The cycle begins anew.

The launch followed its checklist, full or phased as planned. ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

The OKRs and KPIs set in Sculpt were tracked from day one.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

A retrospective was held two to four weeks after launch.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

A decision was taken on the data: iterate, scale or sunset.

☐ Yes ☐ Not vet

The lessons are written into the next Ignite, and the cycle begins anew.

☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

☐ Iterate ☐ Scale ☐ Sunset

☐ Iterate ☐ Scale ☐ Sunset

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The ten techniques

- Brainstorming · Ignite
- The 5 Whys · Ignite
- Provocation · Ignite
- SCAMPER · Forge
- TRIZ · Forge
- Mind mapping · Forge
- Design Thinking · Temper
- Storyboarding · Temper
- SWOT analysis · Sculpt
- Six Thinking Hats · Sculpt



1 / 10

Brainstorming

Ignite

CASE OR ORIGIN IDEO shopping cart (1999); Osborn (1953)

WHEN You need many ideas fast, before anyone starts judging them.

1. Write the challenge as a question: "How might we...?"
2. Set the rules aloud: defer judgment, build on others' ideas, go for quantity.
3. Timebox it: fifteen to twenty minutes, one idea per note.
4. Cluster the notes, then vote; only now is judgment allowed.

Output: A bank of ideas and a short list chosen by vote.

Sheet 1.3



2 / 10

The 5 Whys

Ignite

CASE OR ORIGIN Toyota Production System; Ohno (1988)

WHEN A problem keeps coming back, or the team is about to fund a fix for a symptom.

1. State the problem as a fact you have seen, not a guess.
2. Ask "why?" and write the answer; ask again of that answer.
3. Stop when the answer is something you can act on and prevent.
4. Check the chain backwards: does each cause really lead to the next?

Output: A root cause worth solving, in one sentence.

Sheet 1.1



3 / 10

Provocation

Ignite

CASE OR ORIGIN de Bono, Lateral Thinking (1970)

WHEN Ideas have dried up, or every idea looks like last year's.

1. Write down something everyone takes for granted about the situation.
2. Turn it into a deliberately unreasonable statement, marked "Po": reverse it, remove it, exaggerate it.
3. Do not judge the provocation; ask what would follow from it.
4. Carry any useful principle back to a practical idea.

Output: Ideas that ordinary brainstorming would not reach.

Sheet 1.3



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SCAMPER

Forge

CASE OR ORIGIN Osborn → Eberle (1971)

WHEN You have a raw idea or an existing product and want variations of it.

1. Put the idea in the centre of the sheet.
2. Run the seven prompts in order: Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to another use, Eliminate, Reverse.
3. Write at least one answer per prompt, even a weak one.
4. Star the two or three that change the value most.

Output: Concept variations to shape into a concept statement.

Sheet 2.2



5 / 10

TRIZ

 Forge

CASE OR ORIGIN Altshuller (1984); Samsung (1998–2004)

WHEN Improving one thing makes another worse: a contradiction.

1. Name what you want to improve, and what gets worse when you do.
2. Write the contradiction as one sentence: "We want X, but then Y."
3. Try the inventive principles on the sheet, one at a time.
4. Keep the solutions that remove the contradiction rather than balance it.

 **Output:** A concept that resolves its own trade-off.

Sheet 2.3



6 / 10

Mind mapping

 Forge

CASE OR ORIGIN Buzan, Use Your Head (1974)

WHEN The idea has many parts and you need to see how they connect.

1. Write the concept in the centre, in a word or an image.
2. Draw main branches: who, what, why, how, where, how much.
3. Add sub-branches with one word each; let them multiply.
4. Link branches that touch; those links are often the concept.

 **Output:** The structure of the concept on one page.

Sheet 2.4



7 / 10

Design Thinking

 Temper

CASE OR ORIGIN Brown (2009); GE Healthcare Adventure Series

WHEN You need to learn what real users feel and do, not what the team assumes.

1. Empathize: watch and interview the people you are building for.
2. Define: restate the problem in their words.
3. Ideate and prototype: make the cheapest thing they can react to.
4. Test with five to ten users, then go back to whichever step the evidence points to.

 **Output:** User evidence for or against each core assumption.

Sheet 3.3



8 / 10

Storyboarding

 Temper

CASE OR ORIGIN Walt Disney Studios (1930s)

WHEN You want users to react to the whole experience before it is built.

1. Pick one user and one moment of need.
2. Sketch six frames: before, trigger, first use, key moment, result, after.
3. Write one line under each frame: what they do and feel.
4. Show it to users and mark where they hesitate.

 **Output:** The weak frames, found before they cost anything.

Sheet 3.4



9 / 10

SWOT analysis

 Sculpt

CASE OR ORIGIN Stanford Research Institute (1960s)

WHEN Before committing a roadmap, to see the solution against its context.

1. Inside the team: list strengths and weaknesses.
2. Outside: list opportunities and threats in the market or the institution.
3. Pair them: use a strength on an opportunity; cover a weakness facing a threat.
4. Turn each pairing into a roadmap item or a risk.

 **Output:** Roadmap priorities and the first entries of the risk register.

Sheet 4.1



10 / 10

Six Thinking Hats

 Sculpt

CASE OR ORIGIN de Bono (1985)

WHEN The plan needs a full review without the meeting becoming a debate.

1. Everyone wears the same hat at the same time.
2. White: facts. Red: feelings. Black: risks. Yellow: benefits. Green: alternatives.
3. Blue opens and closes the session: what are we deciding, and what did we decide?
4. Give each hat a few minutes and write its points on the sheet.

 **Output:** A plan reviewed from six sides, and the changes it needs.

Sheet 4.2



Conditions and adoption

- 6.1 Creative space check
- 6.2 Creative blocks
- 6.3 Network map
- 7.1 Adoption by audience
- 7.2 Pilot planner
- 7.3 Exit criteria as a rubric
- 7.4 Kick-off workshop

6.1

Project _____

Date _____

Creative space check

A framework is only as effective as the environment it runs in. Rate each statement from 1 (not at all) to 5 (fully), then pick one change.

Physical space

There is light, and the tools are at hand.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Work can stay up on the walls between sessions.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

There is a quiet place and a place to meet.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

One change _____

Mental space

Pauses are protected, not squeezed out.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

There is time to be curious, with no deliverable attached.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Deep work is not interrupted by messages.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

One change _____

Collaborative space

People speak up without fear of being made small.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Different disciplines are in the room.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Ideas are built on, not shot down.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

One change _____

6.2

Project _____ Date _____

Creative blocks

Blocks have sources, and each source has a remedy. Name the signs you notice, then commit to one remedy this week.

Source	Signs I notice	Remedy	What I will do this week
 Fear of failure		Self-compassion: treat the failed test as data, as the principles say.	
 Fatigue		Structured breaks: stop on purpose, before you are forced to.	
 Stagnant routine		A change of scene: another room, another route, other people.	
 Information overload		Time for deep work: protected hours with the inputs switched off.	

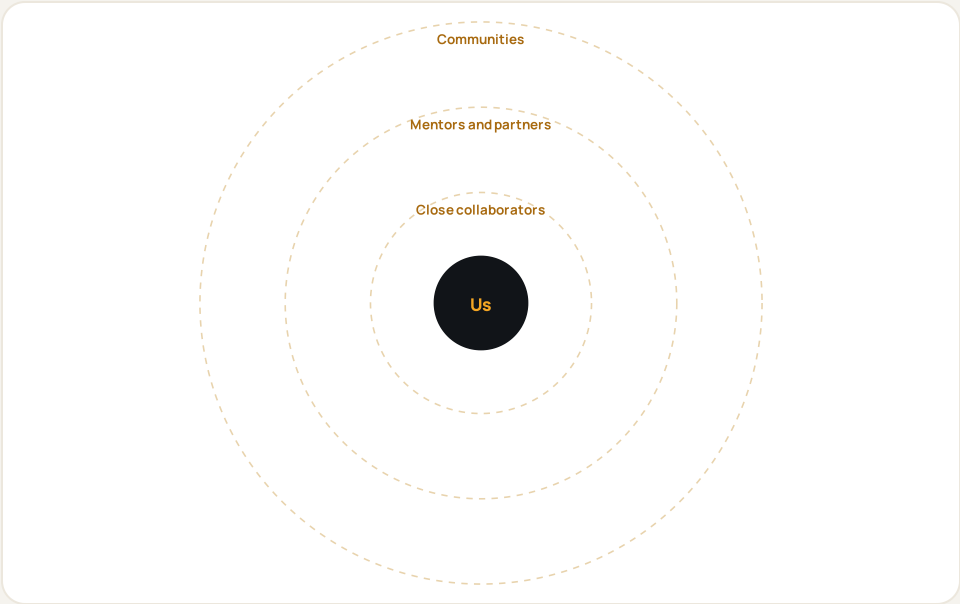
 When the block lifted, what helped

6.3

Project _____ Date _____

Network map

The lone genius is a myth. Map the people and communities who share opportunities, feedback and support, and what you give back.



Person or community	Opportunities · feedback · support	What we give back

7.1

Project _____

Date _____

Adoption by audience

Each audience moves through the same five stages at its own pace. Find your row; the times are a starting point, not a rule.

	 Ignite	 Forge	 Temper	 Sculpt	 Polish
 Students	Weeks 1–2	Weeks 3–5	Weeks 6–9	Weeks 10–12	Weeks 13–14
 Educators and trainers	Session 1	Session 2	Session 3	Session 4	Session 5
 Corporate teams	Weeks 1–2	Weeks 3–4	Weeks 5–8	Weeks 9–10	Weeks 11–13
 Entrepreneurs	Week 1	Week 2	Weeks 3–5	Month 2	Month 3 on
 Academic institutions	Term 1	Term 1	Term 2	Term 2	Year end

-  **Students:** Use a single semester project to move through all five stages; the canvas becomes the assessed deliverable.
-  **Educators and trainers:** Teach each technique inside the stage it serves, and use exit criteria as rubrics.
-  **Corporate teams:** Pilot on one cross-functional initiative for one quarter, with the canvas reviewed at each milestone.
-  **Entrepreneurs:** Compress Ignite to Temper into weeks, not months, and treat Polish metrics as investor evidence.
-  **Academic institutions:** Adopt the stages as a common vocabulary for innovation programmes, and study the framework's outcomes empirically.

7.2

Project _____

Date _____

Pilot planner

Pilot the framework on one initiative before adopting it widely. Decide in advance how you will judge the pilot itself.

 **The initiative**

 **Sponsor**

 Track

- ☐ Students
- ☐ Educators and trainers
- ☐ Corporate teams
- ☐ Entrepreneurs
- ☐ Academic institutions

Stage	Starts	Gate	Sheets we will use
1 · Ignite			
2 · Forge			
3 · Temper			
4 · Sculpt			
5 · Polish			

 **The pilot succeeds if...**

 **What we will change for the next round**

7.3

Project _____ Date _____

Exit criteria as a rubric

For educators and reviewers: each stage's exit criteria become the rubric. Mark the level the work reaches, and say what would raise it.

Stage and its exit criteria		Not yet	Partly	Met	To raise it
	Ignite One to three prioritized problems or opportunities and a bank of initial ideas, recorded on the canvas.	☐	☐	☐	
	Forge A clear value proposition and a low-fidelity prototype ready for first feedback.	☐	☐	☐	
	Temper Core assumptions validated or invalidated with real user data; learnings and pivots recorded.	☐	☐	☐	
	Sculpt A roadmap with objectives and success metrics agreed by the team and stakeholders.	☐	☐	☐	
	Polish Initial performance data analyzed and a decision taken: iterate, scale or sunset. The cycle begins anew.	☐	☐	☐	

Student or team _____ Reviewer _____

Kick-off workshop

A half-day session that opens a project and closes Ignite together, as the paper recommends. Three and a half hours, four to ten people.

Time	Min	Activity
0:00	15	Welcome and the three principles; the ground rules of the charter (0.1)
0:15	15	Frame the challenge as "How might we...?"
0:30	30	Five Whys on the problem as people see it today (1.1)
1:00	30	Inspiration mining, in pairs, then shared (1.2)
1:30	15	Break
1:45	40	Brainstorm, then one provocation round (1.3)
2:25	25	Score and rank: keep one to three (1.4)
2:50	25	Fill in Ignite on the canvas together (0.2)
3:15	15	Ignite gate, owners and the date of the next session

What to bring

- ☐ Printed sheets 0.1, 0.2 and 1.1–1.4, one set per group, plus the canvas at A3.
- ☐ Sticky notes, thick pens, a wall, and a timer.
- ☐ Three to five inspiration sources, gathered before the day.

Facilitator's notes

APPENDIX

Glossary and references

MVP: The version of a new product that yields the most validated learning about customers with the least effort.

Lean Canvas: A one-page business plan that breaks an idea into its key assumptions.

OKR: Objectives and Key Results: a framework for setting goals and tracking outcomes.

KPI: Key performance indicator: a number tracked over time to show whether the work is having its effect.

Pivot: A structured course correction that tests a new fundamental hypothesis.

Exit criteria: What has to be true before a stage is closed; in this toolkit, the gate at the end of each stage.

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InnovaForge

Ideas are abundant. Scaled innovation is rare. These sheets carry an idea through definition, testing, planning and launch without losing its value or its momentum.



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